



Tour de France

Every year, cyclists take to the roads to compete in the Tour de France, watched by thousands of eager spectators.

France

The largest country in western Europe, France is famed for its fine foods and wines, an inspiring fashion industry, its historic chateaux or grand houses, and some of the most stunning countryside.



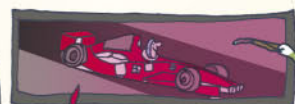
SKIING IN THE FRENCH ALPS

Wine
French vineyards produce a wide range of quality wines that are exported around the world.



Monaco

The tiny principality of Monaco lies on the Mediterranean coast. Every year, Formula 1 cars race around its narrow streets during the Grand Prix.



This is grand.

A winning formula!

Eiffel Tower

Named after its designer, Gustave Eiffel, and erected in 1889 to mark the centenary of the French Revolution, the Eiffel Tower dominates the Paris skyline.



Spain

The south of Spain was once occupied by the Islamic Moors, who left behind many beautiful buildings.



Modern art

The strikingly modern Guggenheim Museum in Bilbao, Spain, designed by Frank Gehry, attracts thousands of tourists.

Flamenco dancing originated in 15th-century Andalusia.



The Iberian Peninsula

Across the Pyrenees Mountains from France lies the Iberian Peninsula, a largely rocky region between the Atlantic Ocean and Mediterranean Sea, occupied by Spain and Portugal.



Portugal

Produced from grapes grown in the north of the country and stored in casks, or "pipes," made from the local oak trees before bottling, port is Portugal's most famous export.



Sardines

The main catch of Portuguese fishermen is sardines, a local delicacy.



Andorra

This tiny nation is unique in having two joint heads of state—the President of France and the Bishop of Urgell in Spain.

This is the first port of call.



Belgium

The Belgian capital, Brussels, is a truly international city since it is also capital of the EU.

Are these french fries or Belgian fries?



Luxembourg

The tiny duchy of Luxembourg has three official languages—French, German, and Luxembourgish—and is a major international banking center.



The Netherlands

With one-quarter of its land below sea level and four major rivers running through it, the Netherlands is kept high and dry by a massive system of dykes and drainage canals.



Rotterdam

Located within the delta of the Rhine and Meuse rivers, Rotterdam is Europe's largest and busiest port.

Germany

The most populous country in Europe aside from Russia, stretching from the North Sea to the Alps, Germany is Europe's major economic and industrial power.



RIVER RHINE

That's one fine Rhine.



FRANKFURTER SAUSAGES AND SAUERKRAUT

Mad castles

Legendary King Ludwig II of Bavaria built three extraordinary, fairy-tale castles in the hills of southern Germany.



Poland

A large, mainly low-lying country at the heart of Europe, Poland has major shipbuilding, electronic, and steel industries, although about a quarter of the workforce is employed on the land.

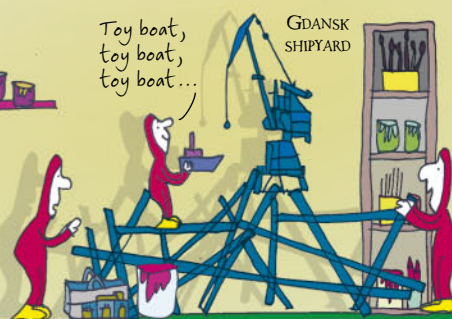


Religion

The Poles are devout Roman Catholics, and many Catholics make a pilgrimage to the shrine of the Black Madonna at Czestochowa, which was painted by St. Luke the Evangelist. Legend has it that the painting protects the city.

Toy boat, toy boat, toy boat...

GDANSK SHIPYARD



Engineering

Germany is famed for its engineering, producing superb machines, such as steadfast cars, and industrial products.



Is it ready?

There's still a couple of bugs.